RAMADAN 2026 · EGYPT · TELECOM ADS

Three races, three winners.

What Vodafone, Orange, e& and WE's Ramadan films won on YouTube and Google Search, Feb – Apr 2026

4
HERO FILMS COMPARED

90
YOUTUBE UPLOADS IN THE WINDOW

12,976
COMMENTS COLLECTED AND CODED

PREPARED BY MICHEL MAGDY · MARKETING ANALYTICS & DATA INSIGHTS

THE FOUR FILMS

Four star-led films, launched within a day of each other

VODAFONE

يا واحشني

“I miss you”

Ensemble cast (Mohamed Mounir, Yasmine Abdel Aziz, Menna Shalaby and others) with a brief appearance by Abla Kamel, her first on screen in years.

18 FEB 2026 · 3:01

ORANGE

نقصاك القعدة

“The gathering misses you”

Amr Diab with his four children. Music by Amr Mostafa.

19 FEB 2026 · 3:04

E&

من قلبي

“From my heart”

Tamer Hosny (with his family) and Saint Levant, with Nelly.

19 FEB 2026 · 2:56

WE

كل يوم أحلى يوم

“Every day is the best day”

Sung by Elissa, with Ahmed Malek, Yasmina El Abd and others.

19 FEB 2026 · 3:57

All four went live on 18–19 Feb, the eve and first day of Ramadan. Each brand also posted cut-downs and offer spots; this deck compares the four full-length films.

Source: YouTube Data API, official channels · views and likes as of 23 Oct 2026 (YouTube only) · cast from press coverage

SCORECARD

No film won every race

	ORANGE	VODAFONE	E&	WE
YouTube views	**334M**	169M	101M	149M
Likes per 1,000 views	0.34	0.74	**1.19**	0.37
Comments per 1M views	10	**64**	26	16
Searches for the ad (Trends index)	**499**	**485**	320	212
Positive comments (sample, n = 50 each)	70%	70%	58%	70%

Reach went to Orange, conversation to Vodafone, approval per view to e&. Search was a tie. Every film was well liked.

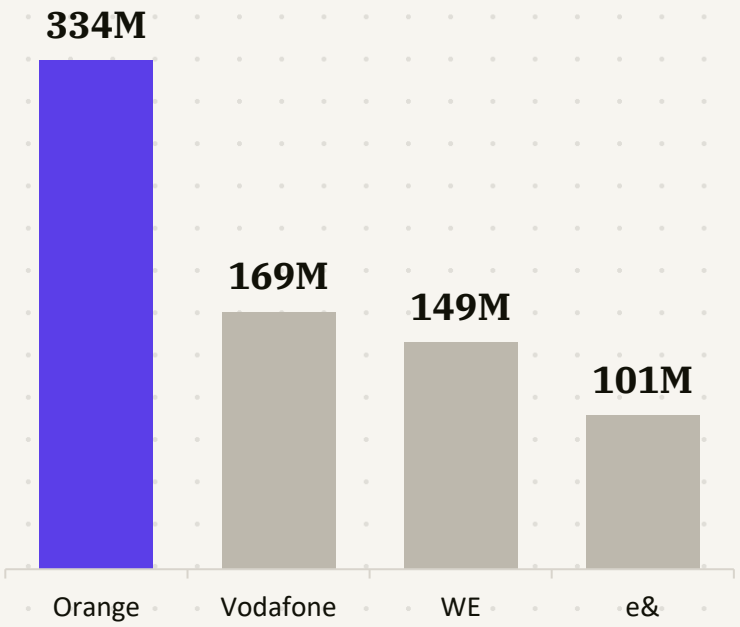
Winner of each row in violet (within 3% counts as a tie). Search = sum of daily Google Trends values for each film's most-searched term in one comparison. Tone differences under ~20 points are within sampling error, so no winner is marked.

Sources: YouTube Data API (23 Oct 2026) · Google Trends Egypt · labelled comment sample

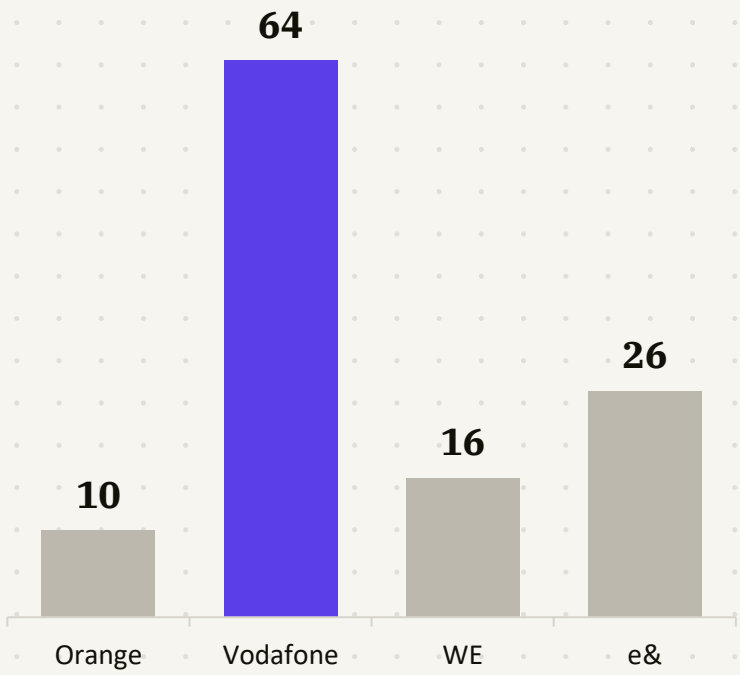
FINDING 01 · REACH VS ENGAGEMENT

The most-viewed film drew the least engagement per view

YOUTUBE VIEWS, MILLIONS



COMMENTS PER 1M VIEWS



WHAT STANDS OUT

Orange had twice Vodafone's views, but Vodafone's film drew 10,852 comments and replies, more than the other three combined (8,236).

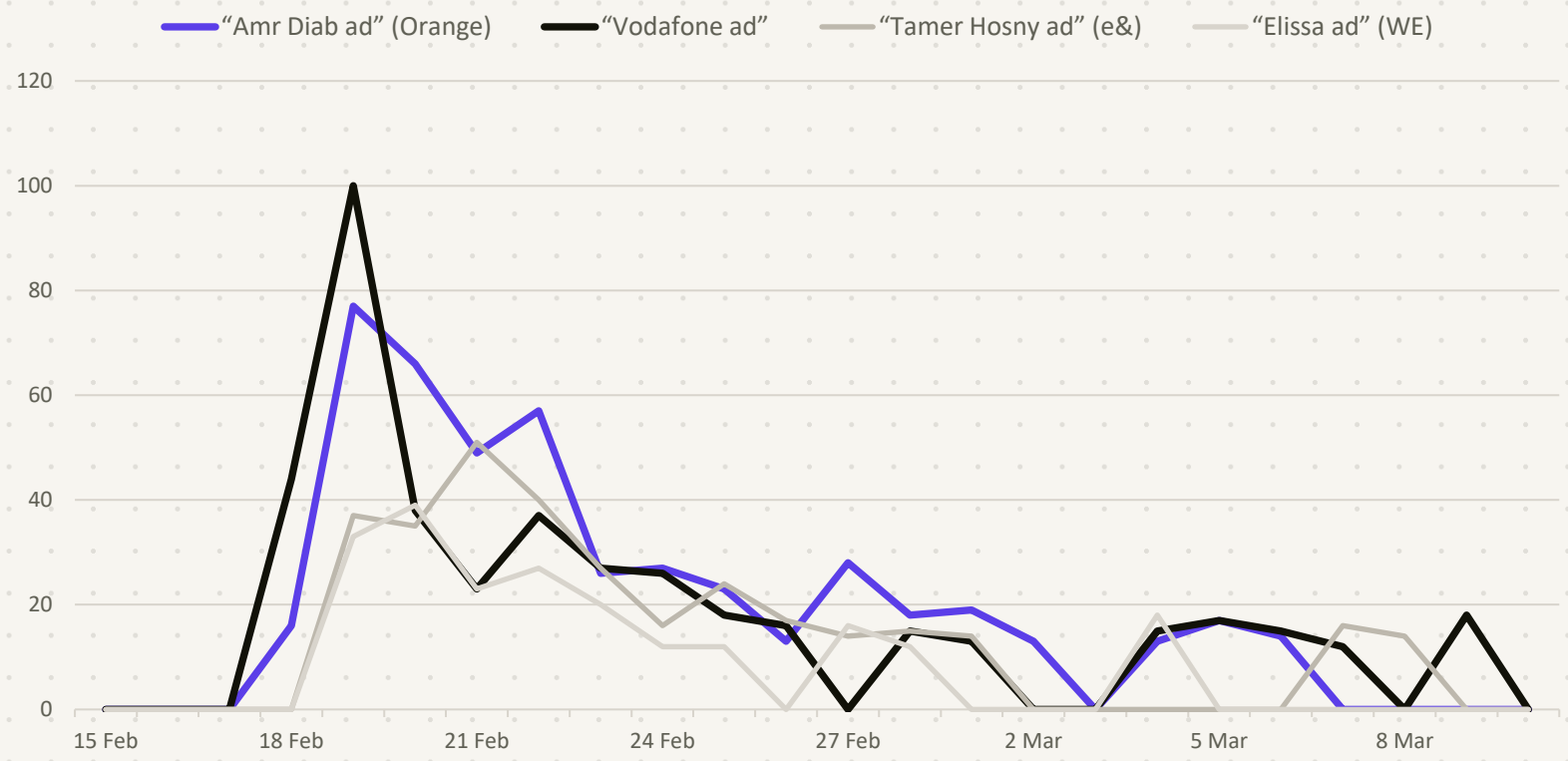
e& had the fewest views but the most likes per view: 1.19 per 1,000, 1.6× Vodafone.

Views include paid media, so per-view rates partly reflect how much was bought. Comment counts are YouTube's totals, including replies.

Source: YouTube Data API, official channels · views and likes as of 23 Oct 2026 (YouTube only)

FINDING 02 · SEARCH

People searched for the star, except at Vodafone



TOTAL SEARCH INDEX

Orange · Amr Diab	**499**
Vodafone · brand	**485**
e& · Tamer Hosny	**320**
WE · Elissa	**212**

Searches for “Orange ad” barely registered, and “Abla Kamel ad” showed up on only 2 days. Searches peaked on 19–21 Feb and fell sharply after the first week.

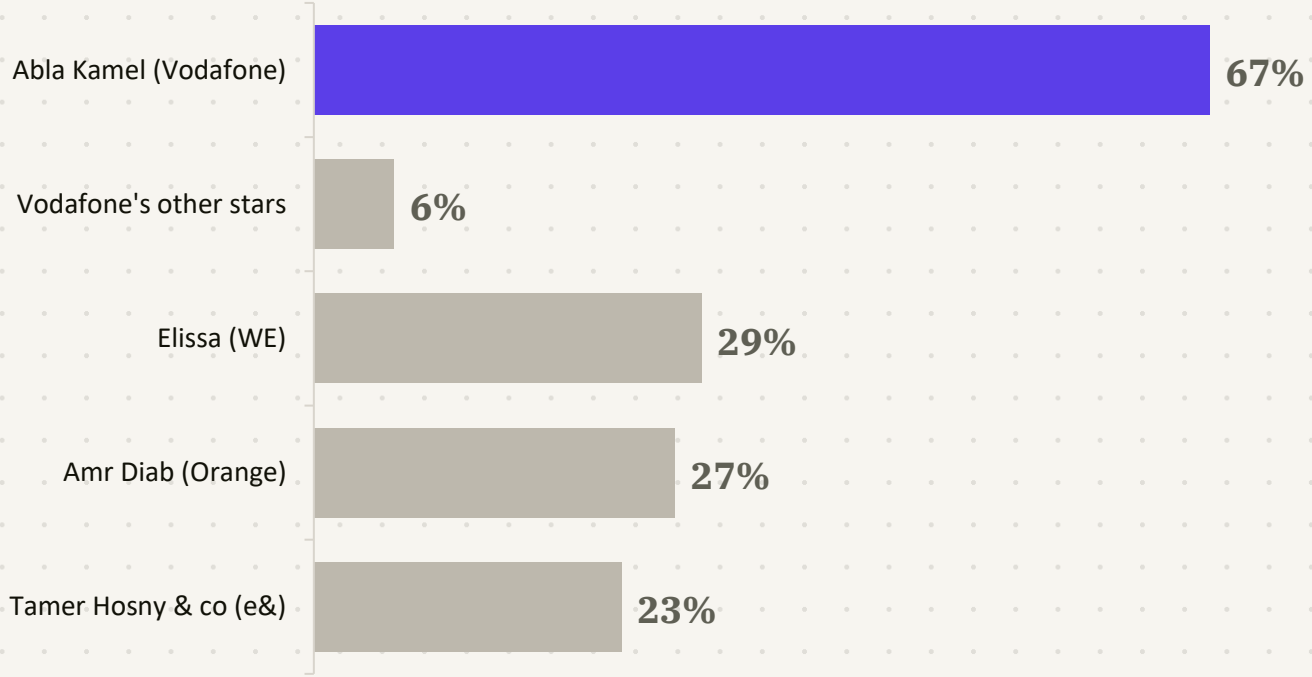
Terms searched in Arabic (“اعلان” + name). Brand-name searches rose only 0–10% in Ramadan vs late January (up to +27% for WE vs early February), so the ads show up far more clearly in ad searches.

Source: Google Trends, Egypt, 22 Jan – 3 Apr 2026, daily · one comparison, shared 0–100 scale

FINDING 03 · WHAT EARNED THE CONVERSATION

A brief appearance out-talked Vodafone's headliners

SHARE OF EACH FILM'S COMMENTS THAT NAME THE STAR



TOP COMMENT · 18,265 LIKES

مين داخل يشوف الاعلان علشان الفنانة الجميلة عبلة كامل

“Who's here watching the ad because of the lovely Abla Kamel?”

Vodafone's comments were also the most emotional: 8% mention tears, goosebumps or nostalgia, vs about 2% on the other films.

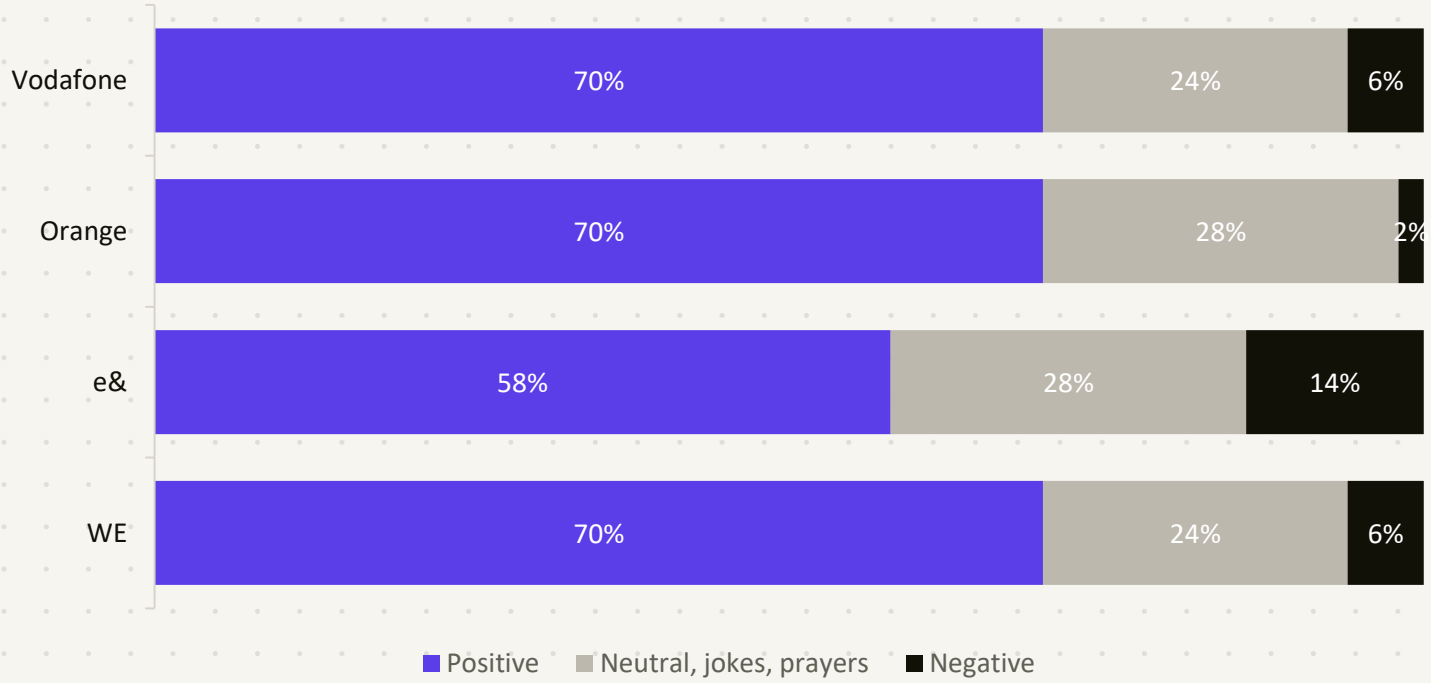
Her appearance was trailed in the press a week before launch; the reaction still dwarfed talk of the film's headline cast. Rule-assisted keyword coding of all in-window top-level comments.

Source: YouTube comments on the 4 hero films, posted 5 Feb – 3 Apr 2026 · no usernames collected · press coverage (Al Jazeera, 12 Feb 2026)

FINDING 04 · REACTION

Every film was well liked; criticism was a small minority

TONE OF A RANDOM SAMPLE OF 50 COMMENTS PER FILM



ALSO IN THE COMMENTS

Song and voice drew the most comment on WE's film (15% mention the song or Elissa's voice), then Orange and e& (9%).

One in 26 comments names another Arab country, mostly greetings (many from Morocco). Egyptian Ramadan ads travel across the region.

With 50 comments per film, differences under about 20 points are within sampling error, so the films are not ranked on tone. Labels drafted with AI assistance; see method.

Source: YouTube comments on the 4 hero films, posted 5 Feb – 3 Apr 2026 · no usernames collected

FINDING 05 · THE SERVICE CONVERSATION

The complaint with the most agreement: data bundles

WE'S FILM · SERVICE AND BUNDLE COMMENTS

5%
OF COMMENTS

14%
OF COMMENT LIKES

55 of 1,044 comments, drawing 1,594 of 11,140 likes. Bundles running out and “unlimited internet” lead the list.

805 LIKES

إليسا دي اللي مصبراني على باقة وي اللي مبتكملش 15يوم

“Elissa is the only thing getting me through a WE bundle that doesn't last 15 days.”

465 LIKES

الباقة خلصت وانا بسمع الإعلان

“My bundle ran out while I was listening to the ad.”

Two joking comments carry most of the likes. The “unlimited internet” demand appears only rarely elsewhere (21 comments on Vodafone's film, 3 on e&'s). A big-budget film invites the “fix the service” reply.

Source: YouTube comments on the 4 hero films, posted 5 Feb – 3 Apr 2026 · no usernames collected

FINDING 06 · CHANNEL STRATEGY

One-film bets vs always-on campaigns

YOUTUBE UPLOADS, 5 FEB – 3 APR 2026, BY ROLE



HERO FILM'S SHARE OF VIEWS

Orange	**98%**	3 UPLOADS
Vodafone	**83%**	11 UPLOADS
e&	**69%**	15 UPLOADS
WE	**28%**	61 UPLOADS

Orange and Vodafone put almost everything behind one film; WE ran a wide offer campaign alongside Elissa's. WE posted about 11 versions of its film, so film-only rates understate WE's engagement.

Source: YouTube Data API, official channels · views and likes as of 23 Oct 2026 (YouTube only)

RECOMMENDATIONS

Four things a telecom brand can do next Ramadan

01 **Judge Ramadan films on engagement and searches, not views.**

Likes and comments per view, and searches for the ad, tell the films apart. Raw views are inflated by paid media.

02 **Track searches for the star, not only the brand.**

People search for the ad by whoever is in it (“اعلان” + name). Both are free to measure in Google Trends during launch week.

03 **Pre-test a beloved face, not just a famous one.**

This season, a brief appearance by a much-loved actress drew more comments than any headliner.

04 **Prepare for the service conversation.**

Have a bundle or offer reply ready on the film's comments in week one. On WE's film, bundle complaints were 5% of comments but drew 14% of the likes.

How this was done, and what it can't tell you

METHOD

- YouTube Data API: the 4 official channels and all 90 public uploads, 5 Feb – 3 Apr 2026. For the 4 hero films, every top-level comment posted in that window (12,976). No usernames were collected.
- Google Trends, Egypt, daily, 22 Jan – 3 Apr 2026. Each chart is one comparison on a shared 0–100 scale; the search index is the sum of daily values.
- Comments coded with Arabic keyword rules (topics such as the star, the song or the service). Naming a star counts as a topic, not a tone.
- Tone comes from a random sample of 50 comments per film, labelled with AI assistance and checked against the rules: 82.5% agreement (165 of 200). The rules miss about half of negative comments, so they are not used for tone shares.

LIMITS

- YouTube only. Press totals such as “1B+ views” add Facebook, TikTok and Instagram, which aren't covered.
- Views and likes are lifetime counts on 23 Oct 2026 and include paid media.
- Trends values are relative; low volumes show as 0. In Arabic, the brand names Orange, WE and Etisalat are also everyday words, so brand-name searches are noisy.
- WE's YouTube channel is Telecom Egypt's. With 50 comments per film, tone shares carry about ±13 points.